

6 29010 002323

TUESDAY

MARCH 10, 2026
RAMADAN 21, 1447

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES

Ramadan Special Offers*

ABC
CARGO & COURIER



800 916
www.abccargo.com

*T&C APPLY

3146923.3.4



UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED VISITS MINISTRY OF DEFENCE

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan visited the Ministry of Defence as part of his ongoing review of recent developments in defence and military affairs, including efforts to enhance operational readiness and preparedness to address emerging challenges. Sheikh Mohamed was accompanied during the visit by Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai and UAE Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence.

OIL, GAS PRICES SOAR AMID TURMOIL IN KEY MARKETS

Energy price surge ripples across economies

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The escalating conflict in the Middle East is sending shockwaves through global energy and financial markets, pushing oil and gas prices higher, shaking stock markets and prompting governments to prepare emergency measures to shield their economies from rising fuel costs.

Oil prices rise on supply fears

Oil markets reacted sharply as traders priced in the risk of supply disruptions from one of the world's most important energy-producing regions.

Brent crude briefly surged to \$119.50 a barrel, its highest level since 2022, before easing to around \$102 as markets absorbed reports that major economies may release emergency reserves. US benchmark crude also climbed close to \$100 per barrel.

The surge reflects concerns that disruptions to production, export facilities or tanker routes in the Gulf could tighten global supply. Roughly one-fifth of the world's oil passes through the Strait of Hormuz, a key shipping corridor linking Gulf producers with international markets.

Higher oil prices are also raising fears of stagflation, where inflation rises while economic growth slows.

Gas markets also tightening

Natural gas markets have also reacted to developments in the region. The UK month-ahead gas price jumped 19 per cent to 163p per therm, while the European benchmark rose 16 per cent to €62 per megawatt hour.

Supply concerns intensified after Qatar temporarily halted liquefied natural gas production



AP

■ A worker gestures after a fuel station in Quezon City, Philippines, temporarily closed when it ran out of fuel.

earlier in the conflict, disrupting shipments from the world's largest LNG exporter. Europe and several Asian economies rely heavily on Qatari LNG cargoes, meaning even short-term disruptions can tighten global supply and push prices higher.

Global stock markets fall

Rising energy prices triggered a sell-off in global equity markets as investors assessed the economic impact of higher fuel costs. Major indices across Europe and Asia fell. The FTSE 100 dropped 1.9 per cent, Germany's DAX fell nearly 1 per cent, and the Stoxx Europe 600 declined 1.5 per cent.

Asian markets saw steeper losses, with South Korea's KOSPI falling 6 per cent and Japan's Nikkei 225 dropping 5.2 per cent.

In the United States, the S&P 500 fell 1.3 per cent, the Dow Jones Industrial Average dropped more than 700 points, and the Nasdaq slipped 1.2 per cent.

Governments move to protect economies

Governments across Asia and Europe are considering measures

to limit the impact of rising energy prices.

Options include fuel price caps, tariff reductions and tapping strategic reserves to stabilise domestic markets.

The G7 is also discussing a co-ordinated release of emergency oil reserves, potentially releasing 300 million to 400 million barrels to calm markets.

GCC economies resilient

Despite regional tensions, businesses across the UAE say operations in key sectors — including ports, logistics, banking and real estate — continue to function normally. Simon Ballard, Chief Economist at First Abu Dhabi Bank, said the Gulf region faces economic headwinds but remains supported by strong underlying fundamentals.

Higher oil prices could push inflation expectations higher while weakening global growth prospects, he noted.

Fitch Ratings has also said regional banks should be able to withstand short-term disruptions due to strong liquidity and capital buffers.

SEE ALSO P8-9, P-1, III

Iran strikes Gulf energy installations

UAE says its air defences detected 15 ballistic missiles and 18 drones

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Iran launched fresh strikes on energy installations across the Gulf yesterday, hitting a petroleum complex in Bahrain and disrupting oil supplies as the regional conflict entered its second week.

The UAE said its air defences detected 15 ballistic missiles, destroying 12 while three fell into the sea, and intercepted 17 of 18 drones launched toward the country.

Regional officials say at least 23 people have been killed across Gulf states since Iran began its attacks, including 10 civilians and seven US service members.

In Bahrain, the sprawling Al Ma'ameer oil facility was struck, causing a fire and damage. The country's state-owned energy firm Bapco declared force majeure, a legal clause used when extraordinary events prevent companies from meeting contractual obligations.

Effect on energy exports

Energy producers in Qatar and Kuwait had earlier issued similar declarations, warning the escalating conflict could affect export commitments.

Saudi Arabia said its air defences destroyed two waves of drones heading towards the Shaybah oilfield in the south-east of the kingdom.

Qatar said it intercepted 17 ballistic missiles and six drones launched from Iran, reporting no casualties.



AFP

■ Smoke billows from the site of an Israeli air strike in Beirut yesterday.

Security tensions have also spread further north, with Nato saying it intercepted a missile heading toward Turkey.

The United States ordered non-essential staff to leave its consulate in Adana and advised US citizens to depart southeast Turkey.

In Washington, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio accused Iran of attempting to "hold the world hostage" through strikes on neighbouring countries and energy infrastructure.

Meanwhile in Lebanon, President Joseph Aoun accused Hezbollah of dragging the country toward "collapse" in the interests of Iran after the group launched missiles at Israel last week.

Unicef said at least 83 children have been killed and 254 injured in Lebanon since March 2 as fighting between Israel and Hezbollah intensified.

The Israeli military said it had launched a new wave of strikes targeting Iranian infrastructure in Tehran, Isfahan and southern Iran, signalling the conflict could widen further.

SEE ALSO P4, 5, 6, 11

Iran picks Mojtaba Khamenei as its new supreme leader

Assembly choice signals continuation of hardline policies

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

Iran has appointed Mojtaba Khamenei, the son of the late supreme leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, as the country's new supreme leader, a move analysts say signals the Islamic Republic's determination to maintain its hardline course amid war and mounting international pressure.

Iran's Assembly of Experts, the powerful clerical body responsible for choosing the country's leader, named the 56-year-old cleric as the successor days after his father was killed in strikes during the escalating conflict involving the United States and Israel.

The decision effectively places one of the most influential yet little-known figures within Iran's ruling system at the helm of the state at a time of extraordinary crisis. Observers say the choice reflects the Iranian



AP

■ Mojtaba Khamenei

establishment closing ranks around a familiar figure deeply embedded within the regime's security and clerical networks rather than pursuing reform.

Mojtaba is regarded as close to conservatives, notably because of his ties with the powerful Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, which swiftly pledged allegiance to the new leader.

Although he rarely appeared in public and never held a formal government position, Mojtaba built significant influence behind the scenes inside the office of the supreme leader, acting as

a gatekeeper to his father and shaping key political decisions.

Iran-Iraq war

Mojtaba, a cleric with a salt-and-pepper beard and the black turban of a "seyyed", fought in the Iran-Iraq war in the 1980s before going on to study Islamic theology at the influential Qom seminary, the centre of Shiite religious scholarship.

Born in Mashhad in 1969, Mojtaba grew up within Iran's revolutionary elite as his father rose to power following the 1979 Islamic Revolution and later became supreme leader in 1989.

Over the years he cultivated close ties with the IRGC and the Basij paramilitary force, both central pillars of Iran's security apparatus. His elevation is widely seen as signalling continuity rather than change in Tehran's policies.

Analysts say the appointment suggests Iran's clerical establishment intends to press ahead with the same hardline strategy at home and abroad, even as the country is at war, under sanctions and rising regional tensions.

SEE ALSO P7



IFTAR 18:29

Fajr	05:16	Shuruq	06:30
Dhuhr	12:32	Asr	15:54
Maghrib	18:29	Isha	19:42

IMSAK 05:06

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



RAMADAN
CAR INSURANCE DEALS



800ALFRED

SPORT

Meet Amna, 1st female driver in Porsche Carrera Cup Asia Pro class | P12



Subscribe In print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com

www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions

Tel: 600 587 234

E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00	Bahrain: BD 0.500	Oman: RO 0.500	India: Rs 40.00	S Arabia: SR 5.00	Pakistan: Rs 100.00
--------------------	-------------------	----------------	-----------------	-------------------	---------------------